Creating a user in **Active Directory (AD)** is a common administrative task. Here are the most common methods.

Method 1: Using Active Directory Users and Computers (ADUC)

1. Open **Active Directory Users and Computers** (dsa.msc).
2. Navigate to the **Organizational Unit (OU)** where you want to create the user.
3. Right-click the OU and select **New → User**.
4. Enter the user's details:
    - First name
    - Last name
    - Full name
    - User logon name (e.g., jdoe)
5. Click **Next**.
6. Set a password and choose the appropriate options:
    - User must change password at next logon
    - User cannot change password
    - Password never expires
    - Account is disabled
7. Click **Next**, review the information, and click **Finish**.

Method 2: Using PowerShell

```
New-ADUser `
  -Name "John Doe" `
  -GivenName "John" `
  -Surname "Doe" `
  -SamAccountName "jdoe" `
  -UserPrincipalName "jdoe@contoso.com" `
```

```
-Path "OU=Users,DC=contoso,DC=com" `
-AccountPassword (ConvertTo-SecureString "P@ssw0rd123!" -AsPlainText -Force) `
-Enabled $true `
-ChangePasswordAtLogon $true
```

To use this command:

- Install the **Active Directory PowerShell module**.
- Run it with an account that has permission to create users.

Method 3: Using Command Prompt (dsadd)

```
dsadd user "CN=John Doe,OU=Users,DC=contoso,DC=com" ^
-samid jdoe ^
-upn jdoe@contoso.com ^
-fn John ^
-ln Doe ^
-pwd P@ssw0rd123! ^
-mustchpwd yes ^
-disabled no
```

Additional Configuration (Optional)

After creating the account, you may want to:

- Add the user to security groups.
- Configure profile paths or home folders.
- Assign a logon script.
- Set department, manager, office, telephone, and email attributes.
- Configure mailbox provisioning (if using Exchange).

- Apply Group Policy settings through the user's OU.

PowerShell Example: Add User to a Group

```
Add-ADGroupMember -Identity "Sales" -Members "jdoe"
```

Best Practices

- Create users in the correct OU to ensure the appropriate Group Policies apply.
- Use a strong initial password.
- Require the user to change their password at first sign-in.
- Follow a consistent naming convention (e.g., firstname.lastname or firstinitiallastname).
- Assign group memberships instead of granting permissions directly to individual users.
- Populate important attributes such as department, manager, and email to support administration and directory searches.